



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śanaiḥ śanair upamed buddhyā dhṛti-grhītayā |
ātma-saṁsthaṁ manaḥ kṛtvā na kiṁcid api cintayet ||25||
indriyebhyaḥ parā hy arthā arthebhyaś ca paraṁ manaḥ |
manasas tu parā buddhir buddher ātmā mahān paraḥ ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verses 25-1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Bhagavad Gītā offers a profound pathway to inner peace and self-realization. Krishna advises Arjuna, and by extension you, to gradually withdraw from the chaos of the external world and turn inward. He suggests a deliberate, step-by-step process: "śanaiḥ śanair upamed buddhyā dhṛti-grhītayā," meaning to slowly quiet the mind with firm resolve. This isn't about forceful suppression, but a gentle guiding of your attention back to the Self. You are encouraged to cultivate inner stillness.

The goal is to bring the mind to rest in the ātman, the true Self. Krishna instructs, "ātma-saṁsthaṁ manaḥ kṛtvā na kiṁcid api cintayet," meaning to fix the mind on the Self and think of nothing else. This doesn't mean emptying your mind completely, which is often impossible, but rather shifting your focus from external thoughts and worries to the inner reality of your being. It's about creating space for the divine within you to shine.

The second verse outlines a hierarchy of perception. "indriyebhyaḥ parā hy arthā arthebhyaś ca paraṁ manaḥ," tells us that the objects of the senses are superior to the senses themselves, and the mind is superior to those objects. Then, "manasas tu parā buddhir buddher ātmā mahān paraḥ," reveals that the intellect is superior to the mind, and the great Self (Ātman) is superior to the intellect. This hierarchy implies that true wisdom lies not in sensory experience or mental activity, but in connecting with your higher Self, the source of all consciousness.

In modern life, bombarded by stimuli and demands, this wisdom is more relevant than ever. You can apply it by practicing mindfulness, meditation, or simply taking moments throughout the day to pause, breathe, and reconnect with your inner being. When you feel overwhelmed, remember this hierarchy: step back from your immediate reactions, engage your intellect to discern what is truly important, and then align yourself with your highest values and your true Self. This will allow you to respond to life's challenges with greater clarity, peace, and wisdom.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what small ways can you begin to gently guide your attention inward throughout the day, cultivating a deeper connection with your true Self amidst the daily chaos?